

matches (in IPL), each one commands a premium. Advertisers pay more per second of airtime. Sponsors pay more per logo placement. The economics of scarcity, usually a disadvantage for shorter leagues, have become IPL's greatest commercial weapon," says the industry insider quoted earlier.

Malhotra believes the kind of generational loyalty that defines fan culture in established sports leagues is quietly taking root in India too. "When I go to England and ask somebody, 'why do you follow Arsenal or Manchester United?', the answer is mostly because their grandfather followed them, then their father followed them. It has become a family tradition. That's slowly building in India too."

52 |

BCCI'S GOLDEN GOOSE

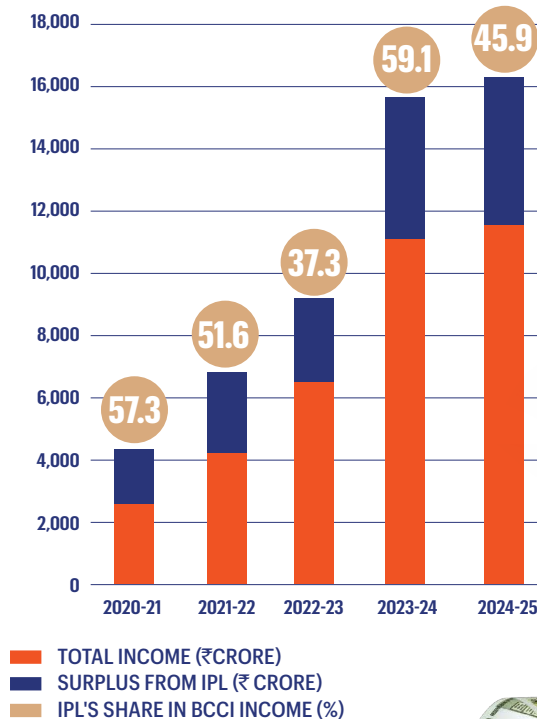
The BCCI is the richest and most powerful cricket board among all cricket-playing nations. It currently accounts for approximately 85% of ICC's global television revenues. In FY25, it earned a total income of ₹11,055 crore, with IPL surplus contributing ₹5,071 crore, nearly half.

That financial weight translates into global influence. The BCCI earns approximately \$230 million per year from ICC, around 38.5% of ICC's annual distribution pool, more than five times what the England and Wales Cricket Board (\$41.33 million) and Cricket Australia (\$37.53 million) receive in total.

THE MULTIPLIER EFFECT

The significance of IPL also creates economic spillovers. Take tourism. According to the Kotak Mutual Fund report, IPL's

THE BCCI'S CASH COW



SOURCE BCCI

2019 edition alone drew nearly 4,00,000 tourist arrivals and \$68 million in hospitality revenue. By 2024, that figure had scaled to an estimated \$450 million, a 6x jump in five years with travel demand surging 60–70% during peak months, the report says. Till 2021, there were eight IPL teams. This increased to 10 in 2021. With it, the number of venues also increased.

Advertisements tell a similar story. IPL has become one of the most premium media platforms in the world, with ad rates scaling

sharply alongside viewership, and sponsorship revenue placing it among the top leagues globally in brand equity.

The employment footprint is harder to quantify but no less real. IPL creates several temporary jobs during the tournament period. The sports merchandise market draws around 40% of its demand from IPL-related purchases. E-commerce sales also witness a significant rise, roughly 25%, during the season. Food delivery platforms report 40–50% spikes on match